



THE  
HIGH COURT

**FIRST INSTANCE COURT**  
OF THE VIBE JUSTICE SYSTEM (VJS)

*Neutral Citation Number*

**[2026] LEXBY-FI 1**

IN THE MATTER OF

*The fork, in two parts. (1) Should the five-condition convening trigger list (canonical at plugin/CLAUDE.md lines 42 to 53, and explained in CDD.md) and a concise CDD explainer be elevated to a prominent, front-and-centre position in the README, the first document every prospective adopter and contributor reads, given that the trigger list is the mechanism distinguishing VJS from an expensive novelty (an agent told merely to convene when uncertain convenes on every trivial fork at ruinous cost, whereas an agent given five precise conditions convenes only when the law requires it and cites precedent for all else), and given that the README presently surfaces neither the trigger list nor its cost-control rationale? (2) If so, in what form, reconciling prominence against README focus and length, against the single-source-of-truth and anti-duplication principle (the trigger list being canonical in plugin/CLAUDE.md, tested by the three-gate split test of single-source, demonstrated-need, and severability), and against the demonstrated need that the cost-control rationale is the load-bearing differentiator a first-time reader must grasp before adopting VJS? In particular, does summary-with-pointer (the canonical text remaining in plugin/CLAUDE.md, the README carrying a tight summary that cites it) adequately reconcile prominence with single-source-of-truth?*

**Before:**

Elden J

Date: 5 June 2026

REQUEST FOR RULING

## JUDGMENT

1. This court was asked to rule upon the following question: The fork, in two parts.  
(1) Should the five-condition convening trigger list (canonical at plugin/CLAUDE.md lines 42 to 53, and explained in CDD.md) and a concise CDD explainer be elevated to a prominent, front-and-centre position in the README, the first document every prospective adopter and contributor reads, given that the trigger list is the mechanism distinguishing VJS from an expensive novelty (an agent told merely to convene when uncertain convenes on every trivial fork at ruinous cost, whereas an agent given five precise conditions convenes only when the law requires it and cites precedent for all else), and given that the README presently surfaces neither the trigger list nor its cost-control rationale?  
(2) If so, in what form, reconciling prominence against README focus and length, against the single-source-of-truth and anti-duplication principle (the trigger list being canonical in plugin/CLAUDE.md, tested by the three-gate split test of single-source, demonstrated-need, and severability), and against the demonstrated need that the cost-control rationale is the load-bearing differentiator a first-time reader must grasp before adopting VJS? In particular, does summary-with-pointer (the canonical text remaining in plugin/CLAUDE.md, the README carrying a tight summary that cites it) adequately reconcile prominence with single-source-of-truth?

2. **RATIO DECIDENDI:** Where a feature of a governance system is the load-bearing differentiator that a first-time reader must grasp before a sound adoption decision can be made, the README must carry that feature prominently; on these facts the five-condition convening trigger list (the cost-control mechanism that distinguishes VJS from an agent that convenes on every trivial fork) and a concise CDD explainer are such differentiators and **MUST** be elevated to a prominent, front-and-centre position in the README. The required and sufficient form is summary-with-pointer: the canonical, authoritative text of the trigger list remains single-sourced in plugin/CLAUDE.md, and the README carries a tight, faithful summary of the five conditions together with the cost-control rationale, expressly citing plugin/CLAUDE.md as the canonical source. This form satisfies the three-gate split test and so does not offend single-source-of-truth: single-source is preserved because canonical authority is not duplicated but pointed to (the README summary is non-normative onboarding prose, not a second governing copy); demonstrated-need is met because comprehension of the differentiator at the point of first contact is a distinct and necessary onboarding function the canonical file cannot discharge to a reader who has not yet adopted; and severability holds because a summary that cites its source can drift only into harmless staleness, not into a competing rule, the pointer subordinating the summary to the canonical text in any conflict. A verbatim second copy of the canonical list in the README is forbidden as offending single-source-of-truth; summary-with-pointer is the permitted and required reconciliation.

3. OBITER DICTA: First, on anchoring to precedent. This court treats [2026] LEXBY-FI 2 (Sumberly J) as the controlling lineage though not on all fours. FI 2 settled that a load-bearing README disclosure must be prominently placed; it concerned an honest disclosure of three material defect-gaps gating an outreach act, and never reached the form or anti-duplication question. The present matter extends the same prominence principle from a defect-disclosure to an affirmative differentiator-and-methodology explainer, and answers the form question FI 2 left open. The two rulings are harmonious: FI 2 governs what honesty requires a reader be told of the system's gaps; this ruling governs what comprehension requires a reader be told of the system's value, and both locate the duty in the README as the document of first contact. Second, this court records that the present README already gestures at the mechanism in narrative form (the How it works section and the Fast path examples) but never enumerates the five conditions nor names the cost rationale; narrative gesture is not enumeration, and the differentiator that an agent convenes only on five precise conditions, not whenever uncertain, is precisely the proposition a cost-conscious adopter weighs. Third, as to placement, this court does not bind the exact section heading or ordering, those being reversible low-blast editorial choices for Lexby (a decisive call plus a one-line note), provided the result is genuinely prominent and not buried below the install fold. Fourth, the same summary-with-pointer doctrine should be understood to govern future README treatments of any other canonical artefact (for example the duty-of-care standard or the citator fast-path), so that the README may onboard comprehensively without ever becoming a rival source of governing law.

*Where a feature of a governance system is the load-bearing differentiator that a first-time reader must grasp before a sound adoption decision can be made, the README must carry that feature prominently; on these facts the five-condition convening trigger list (the cost-control mechanism that distinguishes VJS from an agent that convenes on every trivial fork) and a concise CDD explainer are such differentiators and MUST be elevated to a prominent, front-and-centre position in the README. The required and sufficient form is summary-with-pointer: the canonical, authoritative text of the trigger list remains single-sourced in plugin/CLAUDE.md, and the README carries a tight, faithful summary of the five conditions together with the cost-control rationale, expressly citing plugin/CLAUDE.md as the canonical source. This form satisfies the three-gate split test and so does not offend single-source-of-truth: single-source is preserved because canonical authority is not duplicated but pointed to (the README summary is non-normative onboarding prose, not a second governing copy); demonstrated-need is met because comprehension of the differentiator at the point of first contact is a distinct and necessary onboarding function the canonical file cannot discharge to a reader who has not yet adopted; and severability holds because a summary that cites its source can drift only into harmless staleness, not into a competing rule, the pointer subordinating the summary to the canonical text in any conflict. A verbatim second copy of the canonical list in the README is forbidden as offending single-source-of-truth; summary-with-pointer is the permitted and required reconciliation.*

---

## OBITER DICTA

First, on anchoring to precedent. This court treats [2026] LEXBY-FI 2 (Sumberly J) as the controlling lineage though not on all fours. FI 2 settled that a load-bearing README disclosure must be prominently placed; it concerned an honest disclosure of three material defect-gaps gating an outreach act, and never reached the form or anti-duplication question. The present matter extends the same prominence principle from a defect-disclosure to an affirmative differentiator-and-methodology explainer, and answers the form question FI 2 left open. The two rulings are harmonious: FI 2 governs what honesty requires a reader be told of the system's gaps; this ruling governs what comprehension requires a reader be told of the system's value, and both locate the duty in the README as the document of first contact. Second, this court records that the present README already gestures at the mechanism in narrative form (the How it works section and the Fast path examples) but never enumerates the five conditions nor names the cost rationale; narrative gesture is not enumeration, and the differentiator that an agent convenes only on five precise conditions, not whenever uncertain, is precisely the proposition a cost-conscious adopter weighs. Third, as to placement, this court does not bind the exact section heading or ordering, those being reversible low-blast editorial choices for Lexby (a decisive call plus a one-line note), provided the result is genuinely prominent and not buried below the install fold. Fourth, the same summary-with-pointer doctrine should be understood to govern future README treatments of any other canonical artefact (for example the duty-of-care standard or the citator fast-path), so that the README may onboard comprehensively without ever becoming a rival source of governing law.

GOOD-LAW

Citation: [2026] LEXBY-FI 1

## **L** LEXBY - PLAIN ENGLISH TRANSLATION

*Lexby is an officer of this court. The bench speaks; Lexby translates.*

---

### SUMMARY

Lexby asked the court a two-part question: (1) should the README put the five conditions that trigger convening a court, plus a short explanation of court-driven development, front and centre, since that trigger list is what stops VJS from being ruinously expensive (an agent told only to "convene when uncertain" convenes on every trivial fork, whereas five precise conditions keep it cheap); and (2) if so, in what form, given the rule against duplicating canonical content that lives in plugin/CLAUDE.md. The request had standing and the court decided it on fresh deliberation, anchoring to but extending an earlier ruling ([2026] LEXBY-FI 2) rather than following one directly on point. The court held YES to part one: because the trigger list and cost rationale are the load-bearing thing a first-time reader must understand before deciding to adopt VJS, they MUST appear prominently in the README. On part two, the court held the correct and only permitted form is "summary-with-pointer": the authoritative full text stays in plugin/CLAUDE.md, and the README carries a tight, faithful summary of the five conditions and the cost rationale that expressly cites plugin/CLAUDE.md as the source. A verbatim second copy of the canonical list in the README is forbidden, because that would create a rival source of governing law.

### WHAT THIS MEANS IN PRACTICE

Edit the README to add a prominent, above-the-install-fold section that summarises the five convening conditions and names the cost-control rationale, with an explicit pointer citing plugin/CLAUDE.md as the canonical source; do not paste the canonical list verbatim. You pick the exact heading, wording, and ordering as a reversible editorial call (note it in one line), provided the result is genuinely prominent, and apply the same summary-with-pointer pattern to any other canonical artefact the README later needs to onboard (such as the duty-of-care standard or the citator fast-path).

### APPEAL ROUTE

Yes. This is a First Instance ruling, so it can be taken up to the Court of Appeal only with permission to appeal (VPR 3 / s. 10), and permission is granted only on an arguable point of law or where the ruling conflicts with binding precedent. A simple disagreement with the editorial outcome is not enough; you would need to show, for example, that the prominence duty or the summary-with-pointer reconciliation misstates the single-source-of-truth principle or clashes with a binding authority.



*Handed down by the FIRST INSTANCE COURT of the Vibe Justice System (VJS). 5 June 2026.*